

Typhoons and Community: Coming Home Through Data

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CS 150: Community Action Computing





The Philippines and Typhoons

- 20 typhoons on average per year
- 8-9 make landfall
- High human, economic, and environmental cost
- Vulnerability due to geography

The Cost of a Storm

Ex: Typhoon Yolanda (Haiyan), 2013

- 6,300+ lives lost
- \$2.2 billion in damages
- 4.1 million displaced
- Emotional toll: long-term recovery, trauma, loss







Balikbayan Boxes: A Personal Tradition

- “Balikbayan” means “coming home”
- Symbol of care, connection, and love across distance
- A personal tradition in my family



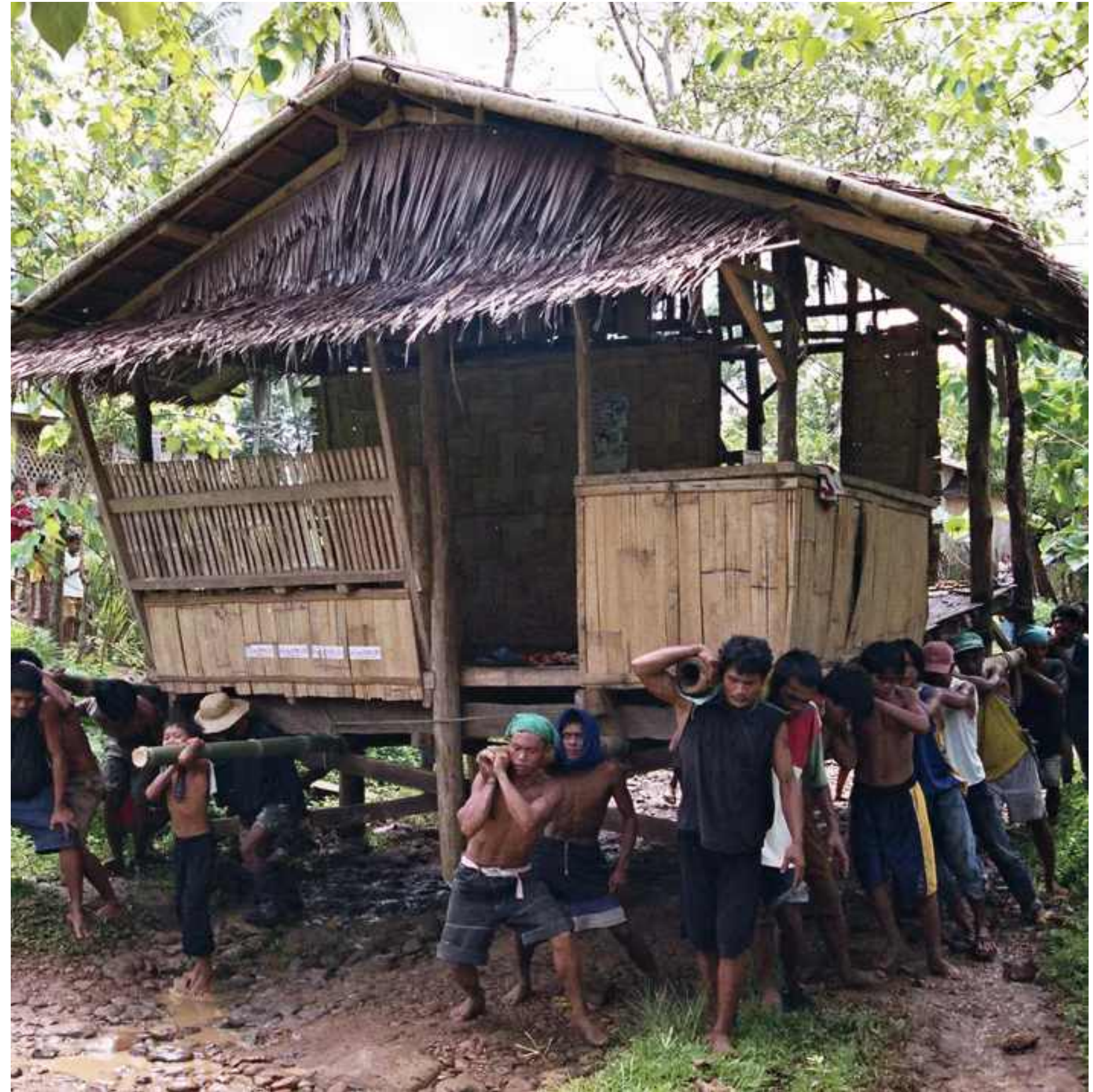


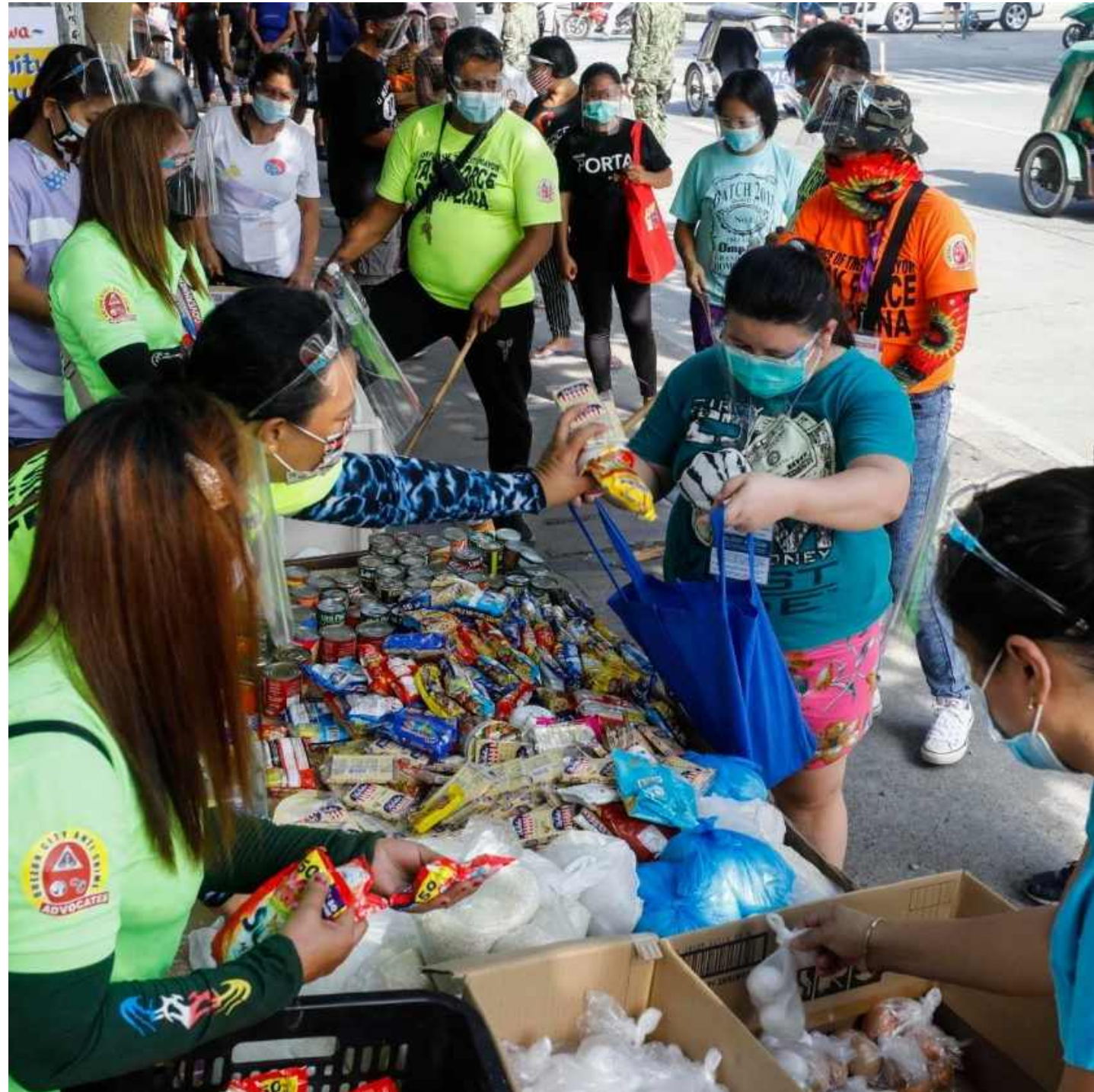
Banyanihan and Relief: A Community Spirit

- “Banyanihan” = helping one another in times of need
- Local + global response: neighbors, families, OFWs
- Aid comes in many forms: food, shelter, remittances, volunteers
- Collective action helps rebuild after the storm

What the Data Can't Show

- Quiet acts of *banyanihan* unrecorded
- Families opening homes to the displaced
- OFWs sending balikbayan boxes
- Community kitchens, boat rescues, etc.
- Weight of grief, hope of solidarity





Why This Matters

- disaster's don't impact all communities equally
- some receive less aid, less attention, less support
- missing data isn't just a gap, but a *signal*
- every act of giving (seen or unseen) holds power

What You Can Do

- support relief drives
- give thoughtfully
- speak up
- look beyond numbers
- practice *banyanihan*



A group of approximately 15 people, including men, women, and children, are standing on a beach at sunset. They are all holding hands, forming a long line that stretches across the frame. The sky is filled with large, dramatic clouds in shades of orange, red, and blue. The ocean is visible in the background, with gentle waves breaking on the shore. The overall mood is peaceful and communal.

Community Means Coming Home